

tougher than installing Alien on a deb-based distribution, but Alien works better on an RPM-based distribution because of the way deb files are made. For those downloading Alien on an RPM-based distribution, <http://tinyurl.com/alienextras> has all the necessary extra packages required to run Alien.

Once installed, Alien will not show up in the menu. Don't worry about this, you will come across a lot of Linux programs like this. This does not mean that there was anything wrong with the installation procedure. This just means that you will have to run the program from the command line. Open the terminal in the folder where you downloaded the RPM package.

Type in

```
$ sudo alien package.rpm
```

In this case, the package name was `darcnes-9b0401-2.3.i586.rpm`

So, in the command line,

```
~/Downloads $ sudo alien darcnes-9b0401-2.3.i586.rpm
```

The terminal will prompt for a password

```
[sudo] password for user:
```

Enter the password here. The password will not show up on the screen. The DEB package should be in the same folder if all goes well.

5.3 Installing from source tarballs

Installing from tarballs is the next best method for installation after the one-click installation. Source tarballs are the most common method of distribution for open source software. This ensures that they work across platforms, across distributions and in many cases are compiled for the specific hardware present on the system. This also makes sure that the software is configured for you as an individual user, and your preferences.

The 'ar' in the 'tar' stands for archive. The 't' comes from tape. The name tarball is a hangover from the times when tapes were used to archive data from computers. When distributed, the tarball is compressed into a format to reduce the file size. This is usually `tar.gz` or `tar.bz2`. The difference between the two is merely different agents of compression, and all Linux distros can handle either format with ease.